By TOUCH DEN · November 11, 2026

Your Learning Roadmap



Video 1 · The Program, and the Foundations

Security Fundamentals · Section 12

In this video, you will learn:

- How the whole program is organized
- Why the Foundations come first
- How to choose a path

How the program is organized

A path from knowing nothing to being ready for work, in five stages:

Stage	Purpose
Foundations	The ground every security person stands on
Offensive	How attacks really work, hands-on
Defensive	How to watch, catch, and recover
Engineering	How to build systems that resist attack
Specialized	Deep fields, and turning skills into a job

Each stage depends on the ones before. ***Rule one: do the Foundations first, in order, and don't rush them.***

The Foundations, and why they come first

"I want to hack things now" is the trap. Those who struggle later skipped the basics.

- ***How Computers Work:*** *you can't analyze what you don't understand.*
- ***Linux:*** *the native home of security tools.*
- ***Networking:*** *the language of nearly every attack and defense.*
- ***Windows / AD:*** *what most organizations run, and attackers target.*
- ***Scripting / Python:*** *automate, and build your own tools.*
- ***Home Lab:*** *your safe, legal place to practise.*
- ***Cryptography:*** *the math behind passwords, HTTPS, signatures.*

The alphabet and grammar before the essays.

Choosing a path

After the Foundations, specialize, matching the role families:

- ***Offensive:*** *you love figuring out how things break.*
- ***Defensive:*** *you like investigating, noticing patterns, staying calm.* ***Most jobs; a reliable way in.***
- ***Engineering:*** *you like building and designing well.*

You can broaden later, understanding more than one side makes you more valuable.

Unsure? Start Defensive: *broadest job market, strong base to pivot from.*

Recap: program and foundations

- *Five stages: Foundations → a path → Specialized; each depends on the last.*
- ***Do the Foundations first, in order**, they're the real base.*
- *Pick the path that excites you; if unsure, start Defensive.*

***Next video:** how to practise, build a portfolio, and your next step.*

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Video 2 · Practising, a Portfolio, and Your Next Step

Security Fundamentals · Section 12

In this video, you will learn:

- Learning by doing: the home lab and CTFs
- Building a portfolio
- Staying current, staying safe, and your next step

Learn by doing: the home lab

You cannot learn security by reading alone. *Reading about lock-picking doesn't make you a locksmith.*

A ***home lab*** *= virtual machines on your own computer: an attacker, vulnerable targets, an isolated network. Everything is yours, so the ethics rule is satisfied by design.*

- ***Do, don't just watch.*** *Perform every technique yourself.*
- ***Break things, then fix them.*** *Attack and defend.*
- ***Take notes*** *(they become your portfolio).*
- ***Reset and repeat*** *with snapshots.*

Practise: CTFs and challenges

Free, legal practice the community runs.

- ***CTFs (Capture The Flag):*** *solve challenges to find a hidden flag, web, crypto, forensics, reversing, pwn.*
- ***Practice platforms:*** *deliberately vulnerable machines, legal because they're built for it.*

Why: legal, graded (you know when you win), builds real stamina, connects you to a community.

30 minutes a few times a week compounds into serious skill.

Build a portfolio

Skills and a portfolio get you hired. *Start now, before your first job.*

- ***Write-ups:*** *how you solved a challenge, the weakness, the fix, skill and communication.*
- ***A blog or notes site:*** *teaching proves understanding.*
- ***Tools/scripts*** *you've written;* ***documented lab work.***

Keep it ***honest*** *(integrity is everything) and* ***clear*** *(a well-explained simple project beats a vague complex one).*

Start your write-up habit with your very next challenge.

Recap: your next step

- *Learn **by doing**: build the home lab, practise with CTFs.*
- *Build a **portfolio** of honest, clear write-ups and projects.*
- ***Stay current and stay ethical**, your reputation for integrity is your most valuable asset.*

***Your next step:** start How Computers Work, continue the Foundations in order, build your lab, and keep notes.*

You've taken the first step. Keep going, and welcome to the field.